Grade 9-11 English Assessment Answer Key

Skill codes: KD Key Details · CP Central Idea & Purpose · CS Craft, Structure & Inference · SS Sentence Structure · VA Verbs & Agreement · PM Pronouns & Modifiers · PC Punctuation & Citation · TR Transitions · VO Vocabulary

#	Ans	Skill	Why it is correct / common trap
1	**A**	KD	Sentence 1: about 86 percent of milk's weight is water.
2	**D**	KD	Paragraph 2: its vitamins and minerals are "not easily obtained from other foods." The passage never compares protein, cost, or availability.
3	**B**	KD	Paragraph 3: milk "does not supply us with the iron we need." The other three are named as contents.
4	**A**	CS	Paragraph 1 covers contents, paragraph 2 its value, and paragraph 3 what it lacks.
5	**C**	CS	Calling the council "friends" is ironic because they voted to tear down the speaker's neighborhood, which is not a friendly act.
6	**B**	CS	The allusion criticizes treating some people as "more equal." The speaker says these residents are already equal to everyone else.
7	**D**	KD	Final paragraph: the families "have the same rights as other citizens" and do not deserve to be forced out.
8	**C**	CP	The speaker asks the council to reconsider a project that will be "a great injustice." There is no new plan (D), and it argues against the council (A).
9	**D**	KD	He was ridiculed for using "other scientists' research and mundane scientific procedure," meaning his work was not original innovation. A is a trap: Fleming is never named as his source.
10	**B**	CS	The sentence supports the claim that the "unusual genius" attracts a great deal of attention.
11	**C**	CS	"Mundane" (ordinary, unexciting) is closest to prosaic. This tests inference plus vocabulary in context.
12	**A**	CP	"For every Fleming... there is always a Jonas Salk": methodical scholars do much of the work. B is too extreme ("superior to all others").
13	**A**	SS	Only A has a subject, a verb, and a complete thought. B and D are dependent clauses; C has no subject or main verb.
14	**D**	SS	One dependent clause (Although...) plus two independent clauses joined by "and" makes it compound-complex.
15	**C**	SS	"When" creates a correct complex sentence. A is a comma splice, B is a run-on, and D is a fragment.
16	**B**	SS	"Especially skiing..." is a fragment. Attach it with a comma. A semicolon needs a full clause on both sides.
17	**D**	SS	"However" between two independent clauses takes a semicolon before it and a comma after it.
18	**D**	SS	The opening phrase must describe the person who was hoping, Nia. The other choices create dangling modifiers.
19	**C**	SS	The items in a list must be parallel: bright, spacious, and comfortable (all adjectives).
20	**C**	VA	"Each" is singular, so it takes "has." "Of the students" is a prepositional phrase, not the subject.
21	**A**	VA	The subject is "box" (singular), not "photographs."

#	Ans	Skill	Why it is correct / common trap
22	**D**	VA	Keep the verb tense consistent with "rang" and "rushed" (past).
23	**B**	VA	In a time clause about the future (as soon as, when, before), English uses the present tense.
24	**D**	PM	Use the subject pronoun "I," and place the other person first by convention.
25	**C**	PM	"Museum" is singular, so use the possessive "its." "It's" means "it is."
26	**A**	PM	"Tasted" is a linking verb here, so it takes an adjective, not an adverb.
27	**A**	PM	"Hardly" is already negative, so adding "can't" creates a double negative.
28	**A**	PC	Put a comma after an introductory dependent clause.
29	**B**	PC	Use a comma before a FANBOYS conjunction that joins two independent clauses.
30	**D**	PC	A nonessential "which" clause needs commas on both sides.
31	**A**	PC	An essential "that" clause takes no commas.
32	**B**	PC	For a singular possessive, add apostrophe + s: dog's.
33	**B**	PC	The comma goes inside the quotation marks, and the dialogue tag "she" stays lowercase.
34	**C**	PC	MLA uses the author's last name and page number with no comma and no "page," and the period goes after the parentheses.
35	**A**	TR	Rain caused the postponement, so this is cause and effect.
36	**B**	TR	Great reviews but boring to me: this is a contrast.
37	**B**	VO	Ubiquitous means found everywhere, the same as widespread.
38	**C**	VO	Scrutinize means to examine closely.
39	**D**	VO	Prolific means producing a lot, so the opposite is unproductive. Influential is a trap: true of Dickens, but not an opposite.
40	**A**	VO	Candid means open and frank, so the opposite is evasive. Honest is a synonym trap.

Answer distribution: A = 11, B = 10, C = 9, D = 10.

Writing Rubric (20 points)

Criterion	Strong	Partial	Weak / Missing
Claim & Position 4 pts	4: Clear, arguable claim that directly answers “more good than harm?”	2–3: Position is stated but general, or wavers between sides	0–1: No clear position, or simply restates the prompt
Reasons & Evidence 6 pts	5–6: Two or more reasons, each with a specific, relevant example that is explained and linked back to the claim	3–4: Relevant reasons, but examples are general or not fully explained	0–2: Opinions with no real examples, or examples that do not support the claim
Counterargument 4 pts	4: States the opposing view fairly and clearly explains why it is less convincing	2–3: Mentions the other side but the rebuttal is thin or missing	0–1: No counterargument
Organization 3 pts	3: Intro with claim, focused body paragraphs, conclusion, purposeful transitions	2: Mostly organized; some paragraphs mix ideas or transitions are basic	0–1: Hard to follow; no paragraphing
Language & Conventions 3 pts	3: Varied sentences, precise academic words, few errors	2: Some errors and repetition, but meaning is clear	0–1: Frequent errors that interfere with meaning

Reading the writing score

Score	What it usually means
17–20	Ready for honors/AP-style argument. Push for nuance, sophisticated evidence, and style.
13–16	Solid structure. Usually loses points on thin explanation of evidence or a weak rebuttal.
9–12	Has ideas but lacks structure. Teach the claim → reason → evidence → explanation paragraph model (CER/ICE).
0–8	Needs sentence- and paragraph-level support first, using frames and modeled paragraphs before full essays.

Overall Level

Total	Level	What it means	Recommended tutoring
90–100	Advanced	Above grade level in reading, grammar, and argument. Ready for honors/AP English and high SAT targets.	1 session/week. AP Lang-style rhetorical analysis, advanced SAT R&W, essay style and nuance.
75–89	Proficient	On grade level with specific gaps, usually 1–2 skill areas or the counterargument in writing.	1–2 sessions/week. Target weak skills; SAT R&W question types; timed essays.
60–74	Developing	Understands main ideas but misses craft/purpose questions; inconsistent grammar; essay lacks structure.	2 sessions/week. Rebuild grammar by error type; active reading routine; paragraph-level writing.
Below 60	Foundational	Below grade level. Likely gaps in vocabulary, sentence boundaries, and reading stamina.	2–3 sessions/week. Sentence-level grammar, core vocabulary, shorter texts, scaffolded writing. Consider a lower-level diagnostic.

Skill → tutoring focus

Skill	If weak, the student usually…	Tutoring focus
Key Details & Evidence	Answers from memory or general impressions instead of the text	“Prove it” habit: underline the line that supports each answer; line-reference drills
Central Idea & Purpose	Picks answers that are true but too narrow or too extreme	One-sentence paragraph summaries; author's purpose verbs (argue, explain, criticize); SOAPSTone
Craft, Structure & Inference	Misses irony, allusion, or why a sentence is there	Paragraph-function labeling; rhetorical devices; context clues for words like “mundane”
Sentence Structure	Writes fragments, run-ons, comma splices, dangling modifiers	Independent vs. dependent clauses; combining drills; SAT “Boundaries” questions
Verbs & Agreement	Matches the verb to the nearest noun; shifts tense	Cross out prepositional phrases to find the subject; tense consistency in own writing
Pronouns & Modifiers	Me/I and its/it's errors; double negatives	Pronoun case test (remove the other person); possessive vs. contraction; adjective vs. adverb
Punctuation & Citation	Comma guessing; apostrophe and MLA errors	Four comma rules (intro, FANBOYS, nonessential, list); semicolons; apostrophes; MLA in-text citations
Transitions	Chooses by sound, not logic	Name the relationship first (cause, contrast, example, sequence), then choose the word
Vocabulary	Falls for synonym/antonym traps; slow on academic passages	Roots and prefixes; 10–15 academic words/week in context; wrong-answer vocabulary notebook
Writing	Lists opinions; skips counterargument	CER/ICE body paragraphs; counterargument + rebuttal frame; timed planning in 5 minutes